green vegetables. Heme iron is found primarily in animal tissues, including red meat, liver, poultry and fish and non-heme iron is found in breast milk, infant formula, cereals, or other grain products legumes, fruits and vegetables. Infants receive most of the iron in their diets as non heme iron.

Tofu, or bean curd, is a popular food derived from soya. It is a staple ingredient in Chinese cookery and is a good source of protein, containing all eight essential amino acids. It is also an excellent source of iron and calcium and the minerals manganese, selenium and phosphorous.

Zinc

Infants obtain zinc from breast milk, infant formula, meat, poultry, liver egg yolks, cheese, yogurt, legumes, and whole-grain breads, cereals, and other fortified or enriched grain products.

Sodium

Healthy, full-term infants consuming primarily breast milk or infant formula of standard dilution receive a relatively small amount of sodium but an amount adequate for growth.

Fiber

Breast milk contains no dietary fiber, and infants generally consume no fiber in the first 6 months of life. As complementary foods are introduced to the diet, fiber intake increases. Dietary fiber is found in legumes, whole grain foods, fruits, and vegetables.

Water

Infants' water needs are met from consuming breast milk, infant formula, and complementary foods. Water is also formed in the body in chemical reactions occurring to metabolize protein, fats, and carbohydrates. Under normal circumstances, the water requirements of healthy infants who are fed adequate amounts of breast milk or properly reconstituted infant formula are met by the breast milk or infant formula alone.

6.2.1 Breast Feeding

Infants who are exclusively breast fed for the first 6 months of life grow well and breast feeding is beneficial not only during this period but also during later years of life. The infant is put on the breast within half an hour after a normal delivery. ***American Academy of Paediatrics(2005) firmly adheres to the position that breast-feeding ensures the best possible health as well as the best developmental and psychosocial outcomes for the infants***

Colostrum: During first two or three days colostrum is secreted in small quantities of about 10-40 ml. The composition of colostrum is as follows:

Table 7 Composition of Colostrum

Nutrient	Quantity / 100 ml
Energy (k cal)	58
Fat (g)	2.9
Calcium (mg)	31
Phosphorus (mg)	14
Iron (mg)	0.09
Protein (g)	2.7
Lactose (g)	5.3
Carotene (IU)	186
Vitamin A (IU)	296

Source: Guthrie (1989)

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